

Day 1 — Why a Capstone? Tour the Menu

Module: Project Implementation · **Band:** Middle · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

By the end of this lesson, students will name the 10 project options, identify the prior module each anchors to, and shortlist two options they’re considering.

Materials

- One printed copy of the project menu per student (lifted from README.md)
- A large sheet of chart paper at the front of the room labelled “Choose Your Project”
- Sticky notes, 2 per student, 2 colours (e.g. yellow for first choice, pink for second)
- A wall display or projector showing the icons/photos of the 14 prior modules

Vocabulary introduced today

- *abhyāsa* (IAST: abhyāsa; lit. “repeated practice”) — the disciplined repetition that turns a draft into a finished artefact. The capstone is a sustained piece of *abhyāsa*.
- *vicāra* (IAST: vicāra; lit. “inquiry, reflection”) — the thinking-step that turns an observation into a question worth investigating. Every project begins with a *vicāra*.

Lesson flow

Warm-up (5 min)

- On the board: “You’ve spent the last *X* months learning frameworks. Today you’ll pick *ONE* and put it to work.”
- Daily prompt: “Name one framework from any prior module that stuck with you. Why?” — 3 students share, 30 seconds each.
- This is the running theme for the module: each class opens with a 30-second share, so everyone speaks by Day 10.

Core (20 min)

1. **Why a capstone?** (4 min) Three things the module does that nothing else does:
 - It asks you to *apply* a framework, not just learn it.
 - It asks you to *finish* — not start six things and abandon them.
 - It asks you to *show your work*, including what didn’t work.“Many of you have done short activities in earlier modules. This is different. You’ll spend ten classes on one piece of work, and the world will see the result.”
2. **Tour the menu** (12 min) — walk through all 10 options, ~70 seconds each. For each, name:
 - the project,

- the prior module it anchors to,
- one realistic-scope example.

Examples to give for each:

#	Project	One concrete example
1	Fermented-foods comparative study	Compare curd setting time at 3 different milk temperatures; document with photos and Ayurvedic tasting notes
2	Mandala / <i>pṛthvī</i> geometry	Design a 9-petal mandala using dot-method, colour each petal with one of the elements
3	Tithi + <i>saṁkrānti</i> + festival calendar	Make a one-month calendar showing tithi, paksa, and 4 family festivals
4	Herb deck	10 cards: front = photo + sketch, back = name + use + part used
5	Magic-square art	A 5×5 magic square turned into a coloured grid (verify it's valid first!)
6	Yoga sequence design	A 10-min sequence for younger siblings, no inversions, 8 poses with rationale
7	Sustainability audit	Measure water at the school rinse-station for 3 mornings; propose one fix
8	Doṣa rhythm self-study	A 7-day chart of sleep / appetite / mood; observations only (not diagnosis)
9	Multiplication comparison	20 problems × 2 methods; report mean time and error rate
10	Open design	Anything anchored to a prior module — pitch it tomorrow morning

3. **Critical safety note** (3 min) — the *pañcagavya* pivot.

*“Some of you may have heard of *pañcagavya* — a traditional Ayurvedic preparation using five cow-derived substances. Two of those substances — cow urine and cow dung — are not safe for school students to handle or taste. So our version of that theme is the fermented-foods comparative study (Project 1), which carries the same intellectual lesson safely. If anyone is curious about *pañcagavya* itself, you can do a library-only research project with parent consent — no handling. Talk to me.”*

4. **One thing this module isn't** (1 min) — a competition. There's no “best project.” The rubric rewards process honesty as much as polish.

Activity (15 min) — Shortlist + sticky note

- Hand out the printed menu. 2 minutes of silent reading.
- 5 minutes: pair-share — “Which two are you considering? Why?”
- 5 minutes: each student writes their **top choice** on a yellow sticky and **second choice** on a pink sticky. Both go on the chart paper at the front of the room.

- 3 minutes: gallery walk. Students see the clusters that form. Teacher counts heads silently.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- “Tomorrow you’ll commit and write a one-page plan. Tonight: skim the project menu one more time. Look at the `sources.md` for the module your top choice anchors to. Don’t pick what you think is impressive — pick what you’re actually curious about.”
- Exit ticket: a single sentence in their journal: **“My top choice is ____ because ____.”**

Student-facing content

Today you’ll meet the project menu and shortlist two options.

A capstone is not a final exam. It’s a piece of sustained work — ten classes from question to share. You’ll pick ONE project, anchored to ONE prior module, and run it from start to finish.

Two new words for this module: - *abhyāsa* — repeated practice; what turns a draft into a finished piece. - *vicāra* — inquiry, reflection; what turns an observation into a question.

A capstone is *abhyāsa* applied to a *vicāra*.

Homework

- Skim the menu one more time at home.
- Open the `sources.md` of the prior module your top choice anchors to (or ask a parent to help locate it).
- Bring your **two shortlisted options** in writing tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **One tier up:** If your top choice is Project 10 (open design), draft a one-paragraph pitch overnight — bring it tomorrow so I can approve at start of class.
- **One tier down:** If you’re stuck between projects, pick by elimination — which one needs materials you can’t get at home? Cross those off first.

Teacher notes

- Resist the urge to suggest projects to specific students. Let them choose.
- Watch the sticky-note clusters: if 8 students all want Project 4 (herbs), you’ll need to cap and re-direct tomorrow. Have a quick plan for which projects you’ll cap.
- The two new Sanskrit terms (*abhyāsa*, *vicāra*) come back in Day 5 (critique) and Day 8 (documentation). Don’t drill them today; introduce and move on.

Citation(s) used in this lesson

- No primary-source citation needed today — this is a process-orientation lesson. Sanskrit terms drawn from `_shared/glossary.md`.